

What is a Servlet Listener(or web application listener)?

During the lifetime of a typical web application, a number of events take place.

eg : requests are created or destroyed.

sessions are created & destroyed

Contexts(web apps) are created & destroyed.

request or session or context attributes are added, removed, or modified etc.

The Servlet API provides a number of listener interfaces that one can implement in order to react to these events.

eg : `EventListener` i/f

Sub i/fs :

1. `ServletRequestListener`

2. `HttpSessionListener`

3. `ServletContextListener`

....

Event Handling Steps

1. Create a separate class , implementing from Listener i/f.

2. Register it with WC

2.1 `@WebListener` annotation(class level)

OR

2.2 XML tags in web.xml

`<listener>`

`<listener-class>F.Q cls name of listener</listener-class>`

`</listener>`

request => `ServletRequestListener`

session => `HttpSessionListener`

context => `ServletContextListener`